

What to do after CAT 2025



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What To Do After CAT Exam? GD, PI Preparation, OMETs



What to Do After the CAT Exam?

The road is still ongoing even when the CAT exam is finally ended. For the majority of candidates, choosing what to do next becomes more stressful than answering questions. The days immediately following CAT are crucial, regardless of how well, mediocrely, or poorly your exam went. Your chances for B-schools, future tests, and the GD-PI-WAT rounds can be increased by doing the appropriate actions. For CAT 2025 test-takers and CAT 2026 candidates, here is your straightforward, useful, and incredibly successful post-CAT roadmap.

After CAT, Take a Day Off to Clear Your Head

You've been keeping your mind active, examining errors, and solving mocks for months. Rest should be the focus of the first 24 hours following CAT. Making smarter decisions and doing better on forthcoming MBA entrance exams are two benefits of having a fresh mind.

Why is this break important?

- Reduces anxiety and tension
- Helps prevent over analyzing efforts, accuracy, or slot complexity
- Helps you mentally prepare for GD-PI and OMETs
- Increases clarity before deciding on the next course of action

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What to Do for the Next 24 Hours

Spend time with your family

Sleep well

Watch something light

Avoid discussing answers or checking random predictions

Start preparing for the GD-PI-WAT if you think your CAT went well.

Start preparing for the interview as soon as possible if you think your performance was mediocre to good. GD-PI preparation takes time to develop, and top MBA schools promptly provide shortlists.

Build Your Personal Story

Prepare structured answers for:

- Tell me about yourself
- Why MBA?
- Short-term & long-term goals
- Strengths & weaknesses
- Your academic/professional journey

Improve Communication Skills

- Practice 1–2 minutes of speaking daily
- Focus on clarity, structure, and confidence
- You do NOT need perfect English — you need clear thinking

Read Daily for WAT/GD

Topics to focus on

- Social Issues
- Business & Economy
- Technology Trends
- Important news (last 3–6 months)

Take GD Practice & Mock Interviews

- Gives you the confidence to speak
- Enhances your argumentation and organization
- Reduces stage fear
- Makes your responses seem natural.

If CAT wasn't successful, focus on the next exams (SNAP, XAT, NMAT, and CMAT).

It's okay if some people don't feel well following CAT. OMETs (Other Management Entrance Tests) are used by many candidates to get admission to prestigious B-schools. These tests offer fantastic substitute prospects.

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Upcoming Exams to focus on:

EXAM	IMPORTANCE
XAT	Difficult VARC + Decision making
SNAP	High- Speed Exam
NMAT	Adaptive tests & Flexible attempts
CMAT	Includes GK, accepted by many colleges

Shortlisting Process After CAT Results

Once CAT result are announced, B-schools begin their shortlisting process based on several parameters.

What Colleges Consider

- Overall percentile
- Sectional percentile
- Academic background
- Work experience (if any)
- Category cutoffs

Shortlists are released:

- On the official websites
- Through email/SMS notifications
- Shortlisted students proceed to GD-PI-WAT rounds.

GD-PI-WAT Preparation After CAT

Due dates are short, therefore preparing for interviews and writing tests should begin early.

Important Focus Areas:

Read opinion and editorial articles

Develop your structured writing skills and raise your awareness of current affairs.

Prepare background-based responses.

Conduct simulated interviews

Structure, tone, and confidence are all important.

Your chances of being chosen in the end might be greatly increased by preparing for the interview.

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Expected CAT Cutoffs for Top MBA Colleges (2025 – 26)

CAT cut off vary by college, category, and program. The following table shows expected cutoffs for top IIM colleges.

IIM	GENERAL	EWS	OBC	SC	ST	PWD
IIM Ahmedabad	95+	80+	75+	70+	60+	70+
IIM Bangalore	85+	75+	75+	70+	65+	60+
IIM Calcutta	75+	65+	65+	60+	55+	45+
IIM Lucknow	90+	82+	82+	65+	60+	60+
IIM Mumbai	85+	75+	75+	70+	65+	55+
IIM Indore	90+	90+	80+	60+	45+	45+
IIM Kozhikode	85+	75+	75+	65+	55+	55+
IIM Udaipur	95	81	81	66	42	42
IIM Trichy	95	81	81	66	42	42
IIM Ranchi	95	81	81	66	42	42
IIM Rohtak	97+	93+	83+	60+	50+	-
IIM Raipur	90	80	80	65	55	45
IIM Kashipur	95	81	81	66	42	42
IIM Nagpur	95	81	81	66	42	42
IIM Bodhgaya	95	81	81	66	42	42
IIM Sirmaur	95	81	81	66	42	42
IIM Amritsar	90+	90+	80+	55+	40+	40+
IIM Sambhalpur	90+	80+	75+	55+	40+	40+
IIM Vizag	80+	72+	72+	45+	30+	30+
IIM Jammu	95	81	81	66	42	42

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Top MBA Colleges Accepting CAT Scores (Beyond IIMs)

CAT scores are accepted by many reputable universities for admission to MBA and PGDM programs.

CATEGORY	CAT PERCETILE (GENERAL)	COLLEGES
Top-tier (99+)	99+	IIM A, IIM B, IIM C, FMS Delhi
High-tier (95-98)	95-98	IIM L, IIM K, IIM I, IIT Bombay
Strong Options (90-95)	90-95	MDI Gurgaon, IIFT Delhi, IIT KGP

What to Do After the CAT Exam?

Your chances of getting into an MBA program might be significantly impacted by what you do after the CAT exam. Having a clear plan will keep you calm and concentrated, regardless of how well the exam went. Start studying early for the GD-PI-WAT, use score calculators to determine your projected percentile, and be aware of the trends in college cut-off scores. You can gain a significant edge by taking these minor actions.

Exams like SNAP, XAT, NMAT, and CMAT are still good options if your CAT didn't go as planned. Being prepared for WAT, GD, and PI is crucial because institutions start shortlisting individuals as soon as the CAT results are out. You can confidently navigate the post-CAT stage and improve your chances of being accepted into a reputable MBA program with straightforward, regular preparation.

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Turn your IIM dreams into reality

Book Your Seats Now !!

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